



KSPCB'S SMALLER STEPS TO MITIGATE POLLUTION ISSUES SRINIVASULU IFS, MS KSPCB

The rapid urbanization drive in Karnataka has its share of adversely affecting our immediate environmental ecosystem and its services. It's an uphill task for the Karnataka State Pollution Control Board to address the challenges of pollution related to air, water, land and other environmental pollutions in general. In order to mitigate the environmental pollution, the board in its capacity regulates and enforces the environmental laws. In coordination with various stakeholders, several initiatives are taken up in the recent past which is yielding positive impacts. Few of the actions taken up are unique and are first of its kind in the region and are briefed below:

- Due to Covid pandemic, World Environment Day was celebrated by the Board using virtual platform that helped to reach over 25 lakh citizens in the state through various campaigns and diverse outreach activities. This was



followed by advocating Ganesha Festival Celebrations among general public to worship turmeric Ganesha through radio talks, TV promotions, videos, appeal from eminent people, bill boards displays, webinars, advertisement on products like Milk sachets, match boxes, incense stick boxes, etc and extensive use of social media such influenced the public across the state celebrate turmeric Ganesha. Through outreach activities helped to reach out 15% of the state population. The impact of this campaign is seen in the reduction of water pollution in the lakes when compared to the previous year.

- Green Deepavali 2020 campaign showed better air quality in the state due to Board's effort to control air pollution. Most importantly using digital platform, AIR/FM Radio, Social Media, the board carried out sensitization and awareness

drive appealing general public to pledge for Green Deepavali, distributed lakhs of lamps made out of cow dung and clay among general public. All these resulted in overall reduction of Noise and Air Pollution across the state during this period by about 30%.

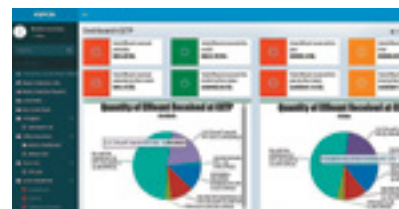
- Emergency Response Vehicles are introduced to attend complaints, patrol illegal discharges in Bangalore, handle emergency situation, collect samples and use drones to give quick response in-situ to the complainants. The vehicles are equipped with equipments to monitor effluents and are manned by a qualified squad.



- The Command Control Centre enabled with GPS technology, servers, manned by trained professional is established to lodge complaints and track it. The Centre is also enabled to oversee the movement of GPS fitted vehicle carrying effluents to CETP and Hazardous wastes to TSDF. It is also poised to display the online data coming from the private STPs.



- KSPCB has introduced GPS tracking to monitor the movement of CETP vehicles in Bangalore. This is ensuring timely tracking and efficient monitoring of these vehicles.
- KSPCB is working towards rejuvenation 17 Polluted River Structure (PRS) for individual PRS along with complying timelines. The water quality is monitored on a regular basis by analyzing the parameters such as pH, dissolved oxygen (DO), BOD, fecal coliform (FC) and total coliform (TC)



- In order to gain Micro, Small and Medium Enterprise's (MSMEs) confidence in the state, a hassle-free registration with KSPCB is made to all the industries operating without the consent to apply for consent from the Board.
- Mobile App is developed, in line with ease of doing business, to reach governance to the stake holders and general public. This is a one-point gateway for the sharing of information on latest Notifications, rules, awareness programs, real time environmental pollution updates etc., KSPCB app can be downloaded from Google play store..
- Monthly magazine "Parisara Vahini" is relaunched to create awareness among general public on environment through technical and interesting articles.
- KSPCB has brought out compendium of environmental laws/circulars
- In order to sensitize citizens about environmental issues and concerns across the state, awareness cum educative radio programmes in collaboration with AIR are being broadcasted on a specific theme every month such as Solid Waste Management at Households and Sewage management which is reaching out to lakhs of people in the state.



In nutshell, small steps are taken by the board up to keep up its regulating and enforcing authority to address environmental pollution. An effort is needed to make these small steps into a long leap to address the challenge of environmental issues and concerns which KSPCB is striving hard.

One can visit www.kspcb.karnataka.gov.in for more details.